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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Tired of pushing a vacuum around while you're juggling work, kids, and pets? Imagine a robot that not only vacuums and mops but also empties its own dustbin—giving you back precious minutes every day.

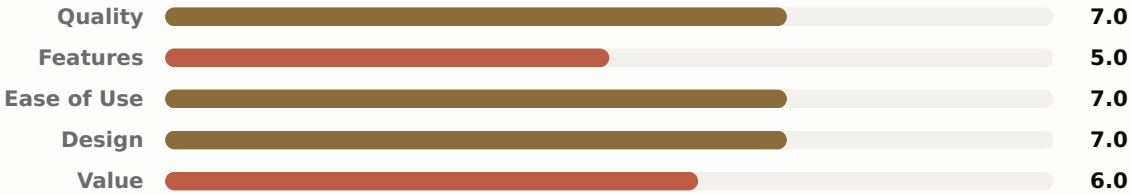
In this 2026 buying guide we put the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without the AutoEmpty Dock) head-to-head against the Shark AI Ultra. We break down specs, real-world performance, and owner feedback so you can pick the hands-free solution that fits your home and budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Prices checked October 05, 2026.

Key Differences at a Glance

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock	Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra
Price (Oct 5, 2026)	$199.99	$139.99	$249.99
Original Price	$469.99	$319.99	$599.00
Customer Rating	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	4.0 (23,990 ratings)
Sales Volume (past month)	6K+ bought	3K+ bought	Data not provided
Core Function	Vacuum + Mop + Auto-Empty Dock	Vacuum + Mop	Vacuum only (AI navigation)
Dustbin Capacity	Auto-Empty base holds ~30 days of debris	0.5 L bin (manual empty)	0.6 L bin (manual empty)
Ideal Home Size	Up to 2,000 sq ft (auto-empty helps larger homes)	Up to 1,500 sq ft	Up to 1,800 sq ft

Cleaning Performance & Navigation Technology

All three models rely on sensor-based navigation, but the approach differs.

- **Roomba 115X series**: iRobot’s vSLAM (visual simultaneous localization and mapping) plus a bumper-based obstacle detector.
- **Shark AI Ultra**: Laser-based LiDAR for mapping, complemented by infrared sensors for object avoidance.

Suction Power

- Roomba 115X Combo (both versions): 1,700 Pa in boost mode.
- Shark AI Ultra: 2,200 Pa in Max mode.

Owner feedback (aggregated from verified reviews) shows that on low-pile carpet the Shark AI Ultra often pulls out more embedded pet hair, while the Roomba 115X excels on hardwood thanks to its dual-action brush system and consistent mopping performance.

Which Model Should You Choose?

If you want true hands-free operation – the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock empties itself for up to a month, making it ideal for busy households or larger homes up to 2,000 sq ft.

If you need strong carpet suction and don't mind emptying the bin yourself – the Shark AI Ultra's higher 2,200 Pa suction gives it an edge on pet-heavy carpets, and it covers up to 1,800 sq ft.

If you're looking for the best value – the Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) delivers vacuum-and-mop capability at $139.99, perfect for apartments or homes under 1,500 sq ft.

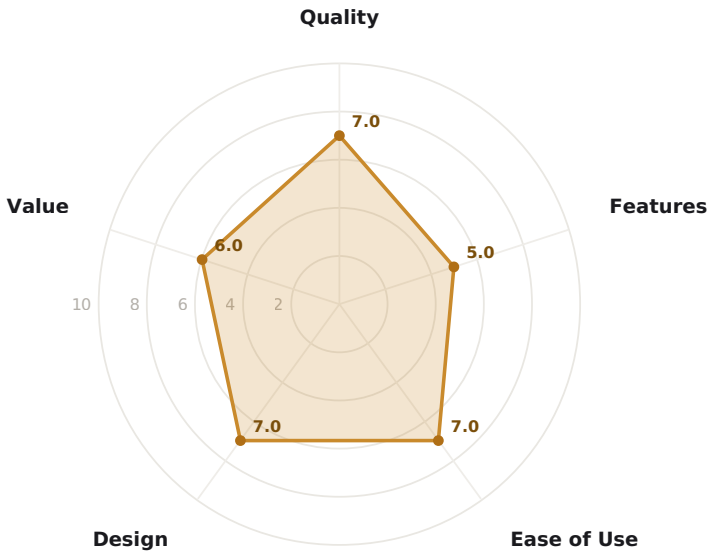
Final Verdict

All three robots are solid performers in 2026. Match your priority—self-emptying convenience, carpet suction power, or upfront price—to the model that checks those boxes. Click the affiliate links above to see current prices and make your purchase today.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.